

InstaDesk

Multi-monitor launcher & window-tiling — User Manual

FcXe Studios · v0.1 · English

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1 • What is InstaDesk?

InstaDesk turns the tedious morning ritual — opening the same apps and dragging every window into place across several monitors — into a single click.

You arrange apps on a visual grid for each monitor, save that arrangement as a **Layout**, and from then on one **Apply** launches every app and tiles it exactly where you put it. You can keep many layouts (work, design, trading, streaming...), bundle several into a **Quick Preset**, or ad-hoc **Snap** a single window into place.

Is it hard? No — the learning curve is quick. But InstaDesk is a power tool with real depth (per-monitor grids, custom launch arguments, browser tab groups). This manual walks every feature; the in-app **Help** tab is the short version.

2 · Core concepts

Five ideas are all you need:

Monitor

You arrange one display at a time. The **Monitor** selector (left panel) chooses which; the **Display Array** shows how your screens are physically laid out.

Grid & cells

Each monitor is divided into a grid of **cells** (e.g. 6×6). You can set a different grid density per monitor.

Region

A rectangular block of cells you assign one app to. A region can be a single cell or a wide band — for example the left half of a monitor.

Layout

A saved set of regions across all your monitors — the heart of InstaDesk. Apply it to launch and tile everything.

Quick Preset

A bundle of several Layouts you apply together in one click.

3 · The interface, at a glance

[Screenshot: the full InstaDesk window — left panel, centre grid, right panel, bottom bar]

- **Left panel** — Quick Presets, the Monitor selector, and the Display Array.
- **Centre** — the workspace grid for the selected monitor, where you select cells and see assignments.
- **Right panel** — tabs for **Apps**, **Layouts**, **Settings**, and **Help**.
- **Bottom bar** — **Snap**, **Clear Present Grid**, **Clear All Grids**, and the per-monitor **Grid** size.

4 · Quick start: your first layout

1. Pick a monitor in the left panel.
2. In the centre grid, **drag across cells** to select a region (say, the left half).
3. Open the **Apps** tab, choose an app (e.g. Chrome), and click **Assign to Selection**.
4. Select another region and assign a second app. Repeat for other monitors via the Monitor selector.
5. Open the **Layouts** tab → + **New Layout**, pick a slot letter, and save.
6. Click **Apply** on the layout card — InstaDesk launches each app and tiles it into place.

[Screenshot: cells selected on the grid with the Apps tab open and "Assign to Selection" highlighted]

5 · The grid & assigning apps

Selecting & assigning

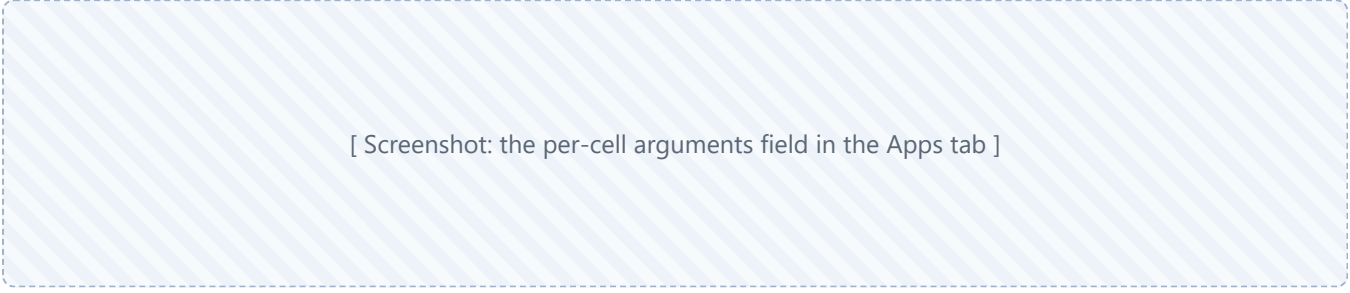
Drag across cells to select a rectangular region, then click **Assign to Selection** in the Apps tab. Use **Unassign Selection** to clear it. Regions must be rectangles.

Grid size (per monitor)

The **Grid** selector in the bottom bar sets the density of the *current* monitor — 6×6 for broad zones, 10×10 for fine control. Each monitor remembers its own size. Changing it on a monitor that already has apps asks for confirmation, since it re-shapes that grid.

Custom launch arguments

Give a cell its own launch arguments in the Apps tab — for example a folder path for File Explorer, so two regions open two *different* folders of the same app. This is how you place several distinct windows of one program.



[Screenshot: the per-cell arguments field in the Apps tab]

Clearing

Clear Present Grid empties the current monitor; **Clear All Grids** empties every monitor (with a confirmation). Saved Layouts are never affected by clearing.

6 · Apps, URLs & Favorites

The right-panel **Apps** tab has three sub-tabs.

Apps

Pick from the built-in catalog, or click **Browse...** to add any program's `.exe`. Added programs are remembered in **App History** for reuse.

URLs — the URL Builder

Build a group of browser tabs that open together in their own window:

1. Choose a **Browser**. Click **+ Add Browser** to pick from the browsers detected on your PC, or browse for a browser's `.exe`.
2. Add a **Tab Group**, give it a title, and add the URLs.
3. Set the **open behavior** (one window, per group, or per URL) and **Save**. The group then behaves like any app you can assign to the grid.

[Screenshot: the URL Builder with a browser chosen and a tab group of URLs]

Favorites

Keep your most-used apps and URLs one click away.

7 • Layouts

A Layout stores which apps go where, across *all* your monitors.

- **Apply** — launches and tiles everything in the layout.
- **Edit** — reopens the layout on the grid so you can rearrange and re-save.
- **Export / Import** — share a layout as a `.json` file.

If a saved app has no program or URL configured, only that one app is skipped on save (with a warning) — the rest of the layout still saves normally.

[Screenshot: the Layouts tab with several layout cards and Apply/Edit/Export/Delete]

8 • Quick Presets

A Quick Preset bundles several Layouts so you can apply them all together with one click — ideal for a full multi-monitor workspace assembled from reusable pieces.

1. Click **Manage QPs** in the left panel.
2. Create a preset and add the Layouts it should include.
3. Back on the main screen, pick the Quick Preset and click **Apply**.

9 • Snap

Snap places a *single, already-open* window into a region — no Layout required.

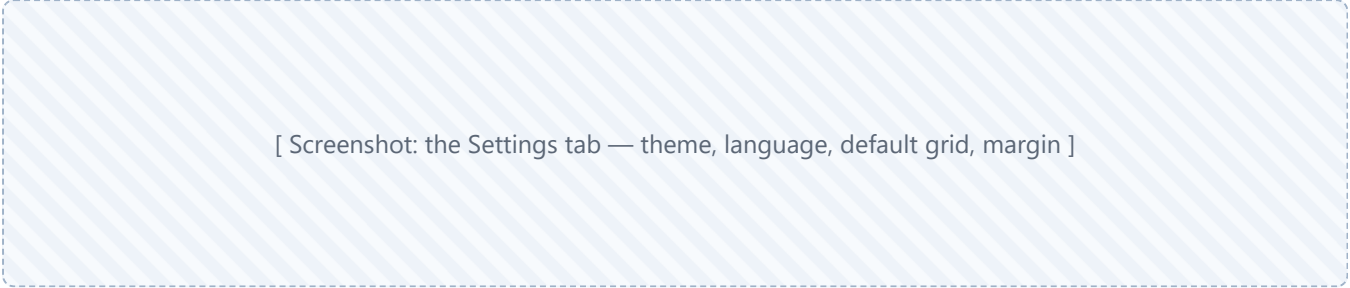
1. Click **Snap** → **M1** in the bottom bar (the number is the active monitor).
2. A grid popup appears on that monitor.
3. Click a region; the window you last used snaps into it.

Some apps enforce their own position (certain CCTV / video tools) and may refuse to be moved.

10 • Monitors & Settings

Use the **Monitor** selector to switch which display you're arranging; the **Display Array** shows their physical layout. The **Settings** tab offers:

- **Theme** — Light, Dark, or System.
- **Language** — English or Español.
- **Default grid size** — the size new/cleared monitors start at.
- **Window margin** — a bezel-aware gap so tiled windows don't sit under your monitor frames.



[Screenshot: the Settings tab — theme, language, default grid, margin]

11 · Tips & troubleshooting

- **An app won't tile.** Some apps (certain CCTV / video tools) place their own windows. Close and relaunch them, or leave them out of the layout.
- **Only one window opens.** Single-instance apps (e.g. Outlook, Teams) open just one window; assigning them to several cells won't create copies.
- **A shortcut won't launch.** Windows shortcuts (`.lnk`) can't be launched directly — point to the real `.exe` in the Apps tab instead.
- **An app fails to launch.** Check its path in the Apps tab and use **Browse...** to correct it.
- **My added browser disappeared / opened the wrong browser.** Use + **Add Browser** and pick a detected browser (or browse to its `.exe`) so InstaDesk has its real program path.